xAI

GROK

GROK BUILD FOR DUMMIES

Your Guide to xAI's Coding Agent CLI

```
$ grok build --help

Grok Build CLI - xAI Coding Agent
  --help    Show this help message and exit
  --init    Initialize a new Grok Build project
  --run     Run your agent on a task or file
  --deploy  Deploy your agent to xAI

Building smarter. Together with xAI.
```

```
def solve(task):
    agent = GrokAgent()
    plan = agent.plan(task)
    result = agent.execute(plan)
    return result
```

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2026

Grok

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Introduction

What Grok Build Is

Grok Build is xAI's terminal-native coding agent and CLI tool. It helps developers plan, implement, edit, test, and manage code inside a project folder using natural language. Unlike a simple chat interface, it operates as an agent that can explore a codebase, propose changes, and execute workflows.

It was introduced in 2026 and is available through SuperGrok plans (including free tier with limits) and via the xAI API. Features include Plan Mode, support for parallel agents in some versions, MCP integration, and ongoing improvements to context handling and permissions.

REMEMBER

Grok Build is a coding agent CLI. It works inside your project directory and can read, plan, and edit code. Always review changes before accepting them.

Chapter 1

Getting Started

Access Grok Build through a SuperGrok account or by configuring an xAI API key. Install the CLI and start a session in a project directory.

1. Sign up for a SuperGrok plan or obtain an xAI API key.

2. Install the Grok Build CLI following the official instructions.

3. Authenticate with your account or API key.

4. Navigate to your project folder.

5. Start a session and describe a task in plain language.

6. Review proposed plans and diffs before accepting.

> **TIP**
>
> Start with a small, non-critical project. Learn the approval and review flow before using it on production code.

Chapter 2

Using the CLI for Coding Tasks

In a session, describe what you want: implement a feature, fix a bug, refactor code, write tests, or explain part of the codebase. The agent explores relevant files, proposes a plan or changes, and can run commands under your control.

Review every significant diff. Use version control so you can revert if needed. The agent works best with clear, specific requests and good project context.

REMEMBER

You remain in control. The agent proposes and executes under approval policies. Always inspect changes.

Chapter 3

Plan Mode, Parallel Agents, and Workflows

Plan Mode lets the agent outline steps before making changes. You can review and edit the plan, then approve execution. Some versions support multiple parallel agents and evaluation modes (such as Arena Mode) to compare approaches.

Additional features include MCP server support for tools, improved context compaction, permission handling, and subagent capabilities. These evolve rapidly—check the current release notes.

> **TIP**
>
> Use Plan Mode for larger or unfamiliar tasks. It reduces the chance of unwanted changes and helps you stay aligned with the agent's approach.

Chapter 4

Models, Context, and Configuration

Grok Build is powered by specialized or general Grok models (such as grok-build variants or later flagship models like Grok 4.x series). Context windows vary by model (for example, 256K for early coding models, larger for others). You can often select models or configure behavior through the CLI.

Configuration options may include permission rules, sandbox settings, and client-side rules that persist across sessions. Local-first designs aim to keep source code on your machine where possible.

Chapter 5

Plans, Usage, and Access

Grok Build is included with SuperGrok plans. Free tier offers limited access. SuperGrok, SuperGrok Plus, and higher tiers provide increased usage limits. Usage often draws from a shared weekly pool across Grok products. Alternatively, use an xAI API key for pay-per-token billing outside subscription limits.

Exact allowances and pricing change. Check the official xAI pricing and usage pages for current details. Monitor the usage dashboard to stay within limits.

WARNING

Agentic coding sessions can consume tokens quickly, especially with large context or parallel work. Review usage regularly and start with smaller tasks.

Chapter 6

Best Practices and Safety

• Begin with small, well-defined tasks on non-critical code.

• Always review diffs and test results before accepting.

• Use version control and commit frequently.

• Keep secrets and credentials out of the codebase and prompts.

• Configure appropriate permission and sandbox rules.

• Provide clear project context and conventions.

• Monitor token/usage consumption.

• Stay updated with official release notes and documentation.

Appendix

Glossary and Resources

Grok Build: xAI's terminal-native coding agent and CLI for agentic software engineering.

Plan Mode: A mode where the agent proposes steps before making code changes.

CLI: Command-line interface used to run Grok Build sessions.

Parallel Agents: Ability (in some versions) to run multiple agents and evaluate results.

MCP: Model Context Protocol for connecting external tools and servers.

Resources

• x.ai official site and Grok Build documentation

• SuperGrok plan and usage information

• xAI API documentation for model access

• CLI release notes and GitHub resources (if available)

About the Author

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This is an independent educational guide. Grok Build features, models, access, and pricing change rapidly. Always consult official xAI documentation for the most current information.